TRACK 3 · AUTONOMOUS AI TEAMMATES

Wapsi

An AI teammate for Paytm's field sales team that wins back merchants who have gone quiet

Team: SLEEPINGFOXES
Members: Ayush Tripathi · Aman Gupta



Quiet merchants cost rent, payments and trust

1.57 Cr

merchants pay for Paytm devices (Q1 FY27), up 27 lakh in a year

₹80–135

monthly rent per device, while rivals charge ~₹50 or give devices free

₹55–90

salary cost of one field visit, at 10–15 visits a day per rep

Why merchants go quiet



Device or SIM stops working
Replacement requests get closed as "area not serviceable"



Money problems
Settlements held; rent cut from payouts without notice



Angry about billing
Rent charged after the box was returned, or charged twice

Competitors poach them
Rival boxes at ~₹50 a month, sometimes free

Today the fix is a costly visit, or no fix at all, and the merchant deactivates.

Sources: Paytm Q1 FY27 results; Rest of World; Business Standard; Paytm field sales job postings; public merchant complaints (Voxya)

Wapsi: an AI teammate that wins merchants back

Wapsi watches every device merchant, works out why one has gone quiet, fixes what it can remotely, and sends a field rep only when a human is truly needed.



01

Detect

Compares each shop to its own normal pattern and flags it early



02

Diagnose

Reads payment, device, billing and ticket clues to find out why



03

Decide

Picks the cheapest fix that is likely to work: remote first



04

Act

Calls in Hindi, sends WhatsApp, refreshes SIMs, raises tickets, books visits



05

Learn

Checks again after 7 days and ranks which fixes work best

JOB DESCRIPTION

Role
Merchant Retention Associate

Reports to
Area Sales Manager

Target
Merchants reactivated per week

It reasons like a detective, not a rule book

Clue Wapsi spots	Diagnosis	What Wapsi does itself	When a human steps in
Box offline, but QR payments still coming in	**Device fault**	Calls in the merchant's language, guides a charge or restart; orders a replacement	Rep visits with the new unit
Box offline, weak signal history in the area	**SIM / network**	Refreshes the SIM session from the network, then guides a restart by phone	Only if the hardware must be swapped
Settlements failing, bank or KYC flag	**Money problem**	Files a ticket with evidence; bank changes happen only in the Paytm app	Support team clears the block
Rent cut from settlement, complaint open	**Billing anger**	Fixes clear billing errors; offers a waiver within its limit	Manager approves bigger waivers
Paytm volume down while nearby shops are normal	**Competitor switch**	Logs the reason, prepares a counter-offer and a brief	Rep visit: this needs a relationship
All payments stopped; seasonal history	**Closed or seasonal**	Spots the yearly pattern and stops chasing	None



Key insight: box offline but QR payments still arriving means the device is broken, not the merchant gone. And a small dip that matches the area trend? Wapsi does nothing.

Humans stay in the loop and in control

Field sales rep

Gets only the visits that need a human, each with a ready brief

"Carry a replacement unit. Merchant upset about ₹135 cut from settlement. 1-month waiver approved. Restart already tried."

Area Sales Manager

Gets a morning summary on WhatsApp and approves offers in one tap

"37 flagged: 22 fixed remotely, 9 visits booked, 2 need your approval, 4 need no action."

Support team

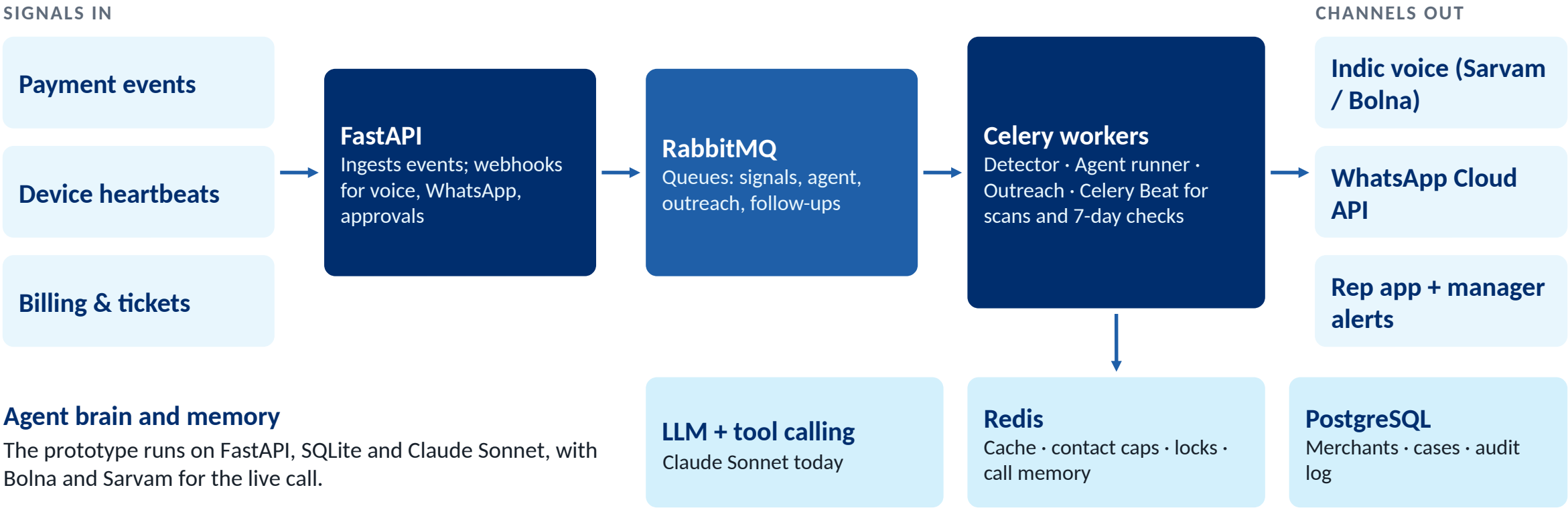
Gets complete tickets with evidence; Wapsi chases until they are closed

"Settlement held 3 days: IFSC mismatch. Evidence attached; merchant sent to the Paytm app."

GUARDRAILS

- Waiver limits per role
- Max calls per merchant a week
- No calls at night
- Easy opt-out
- Unsure? Hand to a human
- Every action logged with a reason

A Python stack built to run at Paytm scale



Agent brain and memory

The prototype runs on FastAPI, SQLite and Claude Sonnet, with Bolna and Sarvam for the live call.

AGENT TOOLS

`get_payments`	`get_device_status`	`refresh_sim`	`create_ticket`
`offer_waiver`	`book_visit`	`send_whatsapp`	`start_call`

Paytm's AI finds merchants. Wapsi keeps them.

Paytm is deploying AI across sales and merchant operations. Wapsi owns what happens after a merchant joins: keeping the merchants Paytm has already paid to win.

	CRM alert rules	Generic voice bot	Wapsi
Finds out why a merchant went quiet	—	—	✓
Fixes remotely before sending a visit	—	Calls only	✓
Hands reps and managers a ready brief	—	—	✓
Speaks Hindi and regional languages	—	✓	✓
Proves its impact against a control group	—	—	✓
Takes real actions: tickets, waivers, visits	Partly	—	✓



Built for Bharat: WhatsApp-first, voice in local languages, for shopkeepers who would rather talk than type.

A kept merchant is worth far more than rent

SIZING (ILLUSTRATIVE)

~₹3,000
earned a year from each device merchant, not just ₹1,200 rent*

~₹12
for a 2-minute AI call to try to save them

~4 L
merchants kept a year if 10% churn and Wapsi saves 1 in 4*

~₹118 Cr
revenue kept every year, and it stacks*

*Paytm Q1 FY27: net payment plus financial services revenue, annualised, per 1.57 Cr devices, rounded down. The 10% and 1 in 4 are assumptions a pilot would test.

Who benefits

Merchants
Faster fixes in their own language; no surprise charges

Field reps
Only visits that need them, each with a brief

Managers
One morning summary; one-tap approvals

Paytm
Rent and payment volume kept; more loan-eligible merchants; fewer complaints

How we measure success

- Back to 70% of normal for 7 days
- % fixed without a visit
- Days to recover
- Cost per reactivation
- Vs control group

Wapsi pays for itself inside Paytm

REVENUE PROTECTED

Money Paytm keeps

- Device rent from merchants who would have left
- Payment volume and MDR on that volume
- More merchants stay eligible for loans and insurance

COSTS SAVED

Money Paytm stops spending

- Field visits for problems fixable by phone
- Repeat support calls and complaint handling
- Device pickups, returns and re-acquisition of lost merchants

ROLLOUT: PROVE IT, THEN SCALE

Pilot
One city, a few thousand device merchants, with a control group

Prove
Cost per reactivation must beat the cost of a field visit

Scale
Roll out across all 1.57 Cr device merchants, city by city

Running cost: about ₹10–15 per 2-minute AI voice call, plus telephony, WhatsApp, LLM and cloud costs.

WHAT WE WILL DEMO

A 3-minute live demo

1. 500 simulated merchants across 20 places and 11 languages: six causes to diagnose, one dip to leave alone
2. 8:00 AM ops board: Wapsi sorts 37 flagged merchants by cause
3. Live Hindi voice call fixes a SIM problem, and the board turns green
4. A billing error is reversed with WhatsApp confirmation; an over-limit waiver is blocked and the manager decides
5. Results: AI group vs control group, visits saved, ₹ recovered (simulated)



Thank you

Wapsi: every quiet merchant, back in business

Team SLEEPINGFOXES